

Element B

There have been no previous attempts from the Nashville zoo to fix this problem but other zoos have attempted to remedy the problem of sedentary komodo dragons with various solutions that are listed below.

Design 1 - Brevard zoo toy

This is solution is from a Brevard Zoo youtube video.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=hpttC5sBGJ8>



This design is very successful as it causes the komodo dragon to run around the habitat and also to use its neck muscles. It is a piece of meat attached to a cable suspending from a cable hanging

over the exhibit. It is also successful because the zoo keepers are able to deploy it simply by dropping the piece of meat and cable into the habitat.

Design 2 - Aussie Dog Zoo Komodo Dragon Interactive tug and Pull Toy

This device is from the Aussie Dog Zoo and can be accessed with the following link.

<https://www.ottoenvironmental.com/product/aussie-dog-zoo-komodo-dragon-interactive-tug-and-pull-toy/>



This design is a piece of heavy duty textile attached to the end of the stretchy band. The dragons use the device by biting upon the textile and pulling while the other end is attached to a handle the zoo keeper is holding or a chain that is connected to a wall. This is semi successful as the komodo will shake it around but fails to entice the beast to run around the exhibit. It also lets zoo keepers deploy it from outside of the exhibit.

Design 3 - Randers Tropical zoo Toy

This was accessed by a youtube video at the Randers Tropic Zoo at the following link.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PTUw8Oh03p4>



It is a square platform of wood suspended by 4 metal cables. A chunk of meat is hung over the platform. This product is successful in the fact that it forces the komodo dragon to use neck muscles to tear the meat down and can be deployed from outside of the habitat. It fails to entice the komodo dragon to run around its habitat and instead the dragon climbs in one part of the habitat.

Design 4 - Atlanta Zoo Boxes

This was accessed by a video posted on the Atlanta Zoo youtube channel at the following link.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RN6UDzTrAIo>



This solution is cardboard boxes filled with food that are placed within the habitat. This is successful because it encourages the dragon to move about its entire habitat and to use its sense of smell which emulates the hunt which it would experience in the wild. One flaw is that it can not be deployed while the dragon could eat the cardboard which would be harmful for its digestive system.

Design 5 - Florida State Pyramid

This design was accessed by a video posted by the San Francisco Zoo on Facebook at the following link.

<https://www.facebook.com/sanfranzoo/videos/male-komodo-dragon-rinca-has-this-enrichment-thing-figured-out-lets-seesmells-li/25268310672852383/>



This design is a bucket with holes in it that has food in it. It is a success because it forces the komodo dragon to push the bucket around the habitat to get food, and can be deployed from outside the habitat. One downside is that the dragon does not run and instead walks.

